

Delaware County Redevelopment Commission - September 10th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oM0inX3SzKA
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Delaware County Redevelopment Commission Meeting Report

Meeting Date: September 10, 2026

Board Name: Delaware County Redevelopment Commission

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the September 10, 2026 meeting of the Delaware County Redevelopment Commission to order at [00:08:55](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Keesling, Commissioner Brand, Commissioner Henry, Mr. Wigerley, and Miss Green.
 - **Members Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Keesling (implied by roll call and opening).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The board stood for the Pledge of Allegiance led by the presiding officer [00:08:58](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Motion made, seconded, and approved by roll call vote to accept the minutes from the August 13th meeting [00:09:30](#).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

[00:09:47](#) City of Muncie MRC Housing Project Update

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. How (City of Muncie MRC)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. How provided an update on the partnered subdivision housing project. He reported that outside parties had urged the developer to route the entering street from the south instead of the north, but neither the city nor county controls or owns that land. Consequently, the project is returning to the original plat design with road access entering from the north as planned and invested. Additionally, the developer's financing institution raised questions regarding the durability of financial commitments if administrations or budgets change; council may look into providing a formal commitment letter.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information only; no formal board action taken.
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[00:14:20](#) West Hill Youth Athletic Association Funding Request

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Austin Brocher (President) and Lauren Schneider (Treasurer), West Hill Youth Athletic Association
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The association requested funds up to \$37,000 for safety updates and capital needs, including replacing a field fence, repairing a rotting wooden batting cage structure, replacing a blown UTV motor used for field maintenance, and purchasing safety equipment (such as safety bases and fence safety pipe systems). They noted that Harrison Township and the Ball Brothers Foundation are funding lighting on the Meguire field, and the township trustee is reviewing a request to pump the septic tank (\$4,250). Board members expressed concern about setting a precedent for funding maintenance across multiple county youth leagues, especially without a direct league financial contribution.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved up to \$5,000 specifically to be used on the septic system/sanitary infrastructure, to be paid out of the I-69 TIF Fund (Fund 4406). Passed by roll call vote (all ayes recorded) [00:31:14](#).
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00:31:49 Storm Water Infrastructure Maintenance Request

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dean Thomas
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Thomas requested \$100,000 to initiate mapping, inspections, and small-scale maintenance (such as clearing drains and removing roots) across more than 100 county-controlled subdivisions. Recent flooding brought light to numerous maintenance issues and property damage risks, and current Stormwater Board resources have been exhausted. Long-term needs could exceed half a million dollars, but this initial funding serves as a starting point while anticipating future FEMA hazard mitigation programs.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved a motion to allocate \$100,000 for the stormwater maintenance and mapping project, split evenly (\$25,000 each) across four separate TIF districts: Magna Industrial TIF (4405), Fountain Square, Midwest Metal, and PRL. Approved by roll call vote [00:38:28](#).
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00:39:14 Park One Second Entrance Update & Paving Updates

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dean Thomas
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Thomas reported that the Park One second entrance project on Route 332 is progressing well, with road closures anticipated to conclude by the second week of October. Separately, out of 13 approved roads scheduled for paving this year, 4 are complete, and the remaining 9 are on track to finish by the next meeting barring adverse weather.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information only; no formal board action.
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00:41:09 Norfolk Southern Funding Status for MIC Trail Project

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff / Board
 - **Deliberation Summary:** It was reported that the Creek Board approved funding for the Norfolk Southern MIC trail project, the claim has been submitted, and payment from the auditor's office to Norfolk Southern is pending. A future request for Z-gate railroad crossing pavement is anticipated.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information only; no formal board action.
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00:44:09 Tabled Business: Patterson Block Funding Request

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Matt and Angie How

- **Deliberation Summary:** The board removed the tabled Patterson Block funding request (\$250,000) from the table [00:44:13](#). The applicants stated they met with the revolving loan fund, which indicated an intention to fund the project pending final scheduling and budget season delays. Board members expressed strong support for the project and the applicants, but raised significant concerns regarding cross-jurisdictional dynamics, noting that the project is a Muncie landmark situated within a city TIF, yet the City of Muncie Redevelopment Commission (MRC) did not hear or entertain the request, leaving the County Redevelopment Commission as a financial backstop for city real estate purchases.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved a motion to re-table the item until communications can be established with the MRC president to clarify their position and reasoning regarding the project. Passed by roll call vote [00:48:07](#).
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[00:59:27](#) Invoices & Claims Approval

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Gina / Board
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed register of claims totaling \$1,210,489.46. Discussion occurred regarding prior unpaid balances for legal counsel (Brooks Jubel), parcel identification clarity on landscaping invoices, and funding sources for Park One and industrial park mowing.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved claims in the amount of \$1,210,489.46 by roll call vote [00:43:36](#) (recorded at [01:04:36](#)).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- [01:05:27](#) **Rick Yenser:** Addressed the board regarding infrastructure costs, noting that property owners in Gaston, Washington, and Harrison are burdened by a \$10 million bond for a new school sewer. He commended the board for addressing county subdivision stormwater issues, noting historical runoff problems caused by decades of unmitigated development and lack of proper storm sewers. He also cautioned against overbuilding housing developments based on Ball State studies showing lagging demand.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Baker Tilly Debt Capacity Analysis:** Discussion on pursuing a \$15,000 TIFF debt capacity analysis. Staff was directed to consult with Baker Tilly regarding timelines relative to the upcoming state legislative session and annual report.

- **Gaston Sewer Funding:** Confirmed that Gaston may proceed with spending previously approved funds (\$500,000) toward their sewer project.
 - **Property Matrix:** Staff (Gina) was tasked with drafting an initial matrix/scoring guide for evaluating proposals on county-owned properties.
 - **Meeting Schedule Change:** The board approved a motion to change the start time of the November 12, 2026 meeting from 9:00 a.m. to 11:00 a.m. (Approved by roll call vote 00:14:56).
 - **Adjournment:** Motion to adjourn passed by voice vote with all in favor 00:15:15.
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